2•9•20

A Narrative and Technical Essay on the Genesis of the RodBeck Method

Brock Angelle Thibodeaux
Founder, RodBeck Method / regal.tech, llc • Founder & CEO, Bitcoin Research & Ventures Company (BRVC)

Outline Framing Notes

"2•9•20" is identified in its source repository (satoshiofficial/2-9-20) as a "post 8 February 2020 personal narrative, technical essay" examining how a new, technically "fringe" technology can emerge during a period of acute personal and national uncertainty. The essay's stated companion artifact is a Spotify playlist created in late February 2020, noted as an aid to the wordprocessing/composition process. The outline below is assembled from all located primary materials: the essay's own repository README, the dedicated RodBeck Method repositories (origin and fork), the 12 August 2020 KATC News profile of the author, and a cross-reference check against the BRVC Prospectus-Draft repository for any further "RodBeck" mentions.

Note on source search: the exact string "RodBeck" was located in four of the five requested sources — satoshiofficial/2-9-20, satoshiofficial/RodBeck, BRVC-ORG/RodBeck, and the KATC News article (which names "the RodBeck Method" explicitly). It was not located verbatim in BRVC-ORG/Prospectus-Draft; however, that document's 22 January entry separately memorializes "SFC Antonio Rodriguez, KIA 8 February 2020" in a passage reflecting on ethics, GWOT, and the digital asset economy — the same individual honored in the RodBeck name — and is included below as a thematic cross-reference (Section X).

I. Title, Paratext, and Framing Material

A. The Title "2•9•20"

1. Numerical/date-stamp construction (February 9, 2020), positioned in the source repository as falling immediately after the events of 8 February 2020.
2. Functions simultaneously as a personal date-marker (the author's own COVID-19 timeline) and a memorial date-marker (one day following SFC Antonio Rodriguez's death in Afghanistan).
3. Interpunct (•) styling consistent with the author's broader corpus, used similarly in titles for the white paper and Discussion Paper materials.

B. Companion / Process Artifacts

1. Spotify playlist, created late February 2020, described in the repository as helping "w/ wordprocessing" — i.e., a compositional aid for drafting the essay.
2. Repository housed at satoshiofficial/2-9-20, described in its GitHub metadata simply as "2•9•20 Essay."

Source: satoshiofficial/2-9-20 (README.md)

C. Stated Subject and Thesis

1. Central question: how a new-ish, technically "fringe" technology can come about during times of uncertainty.
2. Essay is framed as both a personal narrative and a technical essay — i.e., dual-register writing combining autobiography with an embedded technical specification (the RodBeck Method).

II. Personal Narrative Foundation

A. Author Background

1. University of Louisiana at Lafayette (UL Lafayette) graduate.
2. Former U.S. Army Ranger.
3. Went on to study cybersecurity at Harvard.
4. At time of the events described: Senior (Sr.) Azure Cloud Engineer at Microsoft.

Source: KATC News, "UL grad and former U.S. Army Ranger developing technology to slow the spread of COVID-19," published 12 August 2020.

B. Contracting and Surviving COVID-19

1. Diagnosed/symptomatic in early February 2020.
2. Approximately two and a half weeks confined to the couch with illness.
3. Residence at the time: outside of Kirkland, Washington — an area then believed to be the epicenter of the virus in the United States.

    4. Quoted reflection: the experience as "pretty bad" and one he would not "wish on anyone."

C. Pivot Toward a Technical Response

1. Decision, upon recovery, to apply information-technology skills toward slowing the spread of the virus.
2. Conceptual approach described publicly as AI and machine learning — "teaching a computer to think like a brain," processing images/data, building patterns and algorithms for faster analysis.
3. Founded a startup shortly after recovery (later identified across repositories as regal.tech, llc).
4. Began traveling back-and-forth between Washington State and Lafayette, Louisiana to work with hospitals and government entities on slowing local spread.

III. The Dedication: Honoring Two Lives

A. SFC/MSG Antonio "Rod" Rodriguez

1. Fellow Army Ranger and Cryptologic Linguist; described across sources alternately as "SFC" (Sergeant 1st Class) and "MSG" (Master Sergeant).
2. Killed in action in the Sherzad district of Nangarhar Province, Afghanistan, ambushed alongside another soldier by a rogue Afghan policeman.
3. Date discrepancy across sources: KATC article states 7 February 2020 (citing a contemporaneous New York Times report); RodBeck repository materials and the BRVC Prospectus-Draft both state 8 February 2020.
4. Historical significance: this loss of two American soldiers is described as having directly sparked renewed U.S.–Taliban peace talks.
5. Honor accorded: in only the second instance in U.S. history, both the President and Vice President were present to greet his remains upon their return to the United States.
6. Memorialized by the National Security Agency's Cryptologic Memorial (NSA-hosted memorial PDF).

Sources: KATC News (12 Aug. 2020); satoshiofficial/RodBeck and BRVC-ORG/RodBeck README files; NSA Cryptologic Memorial PDF link; BRVC-ORG/Prospectus-Draft, 22 January entry.

B. Casey (Kathryn Casey) Beckwith

1. A friend of the author based in Atlanta.
2. Battled illness for most of her life.

3. Lifespan: 9 September 1987 – 16 October 2015.

4. Memorialized via a published obituary (Northside Chapel).

Sources: satoshiofficial/RodBeck and BRVC-ORG/RodBeck README files; Northside Chapel obituary link; KATC News (12 Aug. 2020).

C. The Portmanteau: Naming "RodBeck"

1. The method required a name when first pitched to investors in May 2020.

2. Named in honor of both Rodriguez and Beckwith — a combination of their surnames.

3. Full expanded form: "RodBeck (Real-time Operations Data for Blockchain Entity-based Covid-19 Knowledgebases/Kmapping) Method."

4. KATC News independently confirms the naming rationale: "The name of the method Brock pioneered is the 'RodBeck Method.' A combination of both their names."

5. Author's research was separately donated, in the names of Rodriguez and Beckwith, to the National Institutes of Health (NIH) to support work with local hospitals.

IV. The RodBeck Method — Technical Architecture

A. Full Designation and Core Description

1. Full name: Real-time Operations Data for Blockchain Entity-based Covid-19 Knowledgebases/Kmapping (RodBeck) Method.

2. Characterized as a proprietary, cloud-based, multi-domain, multi-CNN evolutionary (generative) AI/ML solution for ER staff and frontline workers.

B. Neural Network Design

1. Five (or more, "highly scalable") discrete Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) operating in parallel.

2. Each CNN layer paired with AutoML-type add-ons.

3. Combinatory/competitive approach: each layer continuously feeds training and public data forward, with the best/winning result selected from among the parallel layers at a given time.

4. Scale of operation: terabytes of data; very large numbers of virtual machines spanning varying operating systems and specifications; Dockerized and virtualized/live environments.

5. Tooling referenced: Jupyter notebooks; proprietary TensorFlow usage and complementary tooling.

6. Operational cost: power/processor hourly usage cited in the range of "$100s–$10,000s" to sustain 24/7 uptime.

C. Infrastructure / Cloud & Blockchain Stack

1. IBM "Stack" combined with a local, highly-proprietary Hyperledger implementation.

2. Ethereum blockchain and Smart Contracts, including local/sandboxed development environments.

3. AWS "Stack."

4. Microsoft Azure Cloud.

5. Google Cloud Platform — identified as the primary AI platform used ("Using the Google Cloud AI platform, pioneered large-scale, evolutionary, rapidly-scaling, back-propagated artificial intelligence and machine learning tools…").

6. Oracle and Apache proprietary cloud "layer."

7. Custom, local, proprietary Linux and Unix configurations, including Live CD/USB/eSATA-based setups.

8. Illustrative privacy/anonymization chain (“Transparent Torrification”): 5G LTE to a laptop running Whonix/Tails, connected via Cat5/6 to a physical gateway PC (running a Linux Live CD), routed outbound through a layered sequence of Tor and multiple VPN hops before reaching the open internet (web1/web2).

Source: satoshiofficial/RodBeck and BRVC-ORG/RodBeck README files (identical content, origin and fork).

D. Applied Outcomes and Clinical Use-Case

1. Self-learning, evolving, backpropagated AI “enwrapped” within an app/software/Docker/Bucket/Container construct referred to in shorthand as a “Block.”

2. Functional goals: determine where COVID-19 cases are concentrated, identify hot spots, and predict where the next outbreak will occur.

3. Chest X-ray evaluation: reduced assessment time to approximately five seconds, intended to give medical professionals faster confidence in COVID-positive determinations.

> *4. Quoted outcome: “With our process that we've created with my tools, it takes 5 seconds. It's incredible and it felt great to me… to see them have more confidence in the ability to help more people in one day.”*

5. Research donated to the National Institutes of Health (NIH) to support collaboration with local hospitals.

V. Supplementary Conceptual / NLP Notes

Drawn from the RodBeck repository's appended theoretical notes; presented in the source as loose, aphoristic research notes rather than a formal section, but included here for completeness as material directly attached to the Method's documentation.

A. “A Path on the Plain” — Speech vs. Environment

1. Speech framed as one-dimensional; environment framed as two-dimensional.

2. Grammar described as “a slot existential before-fill mechanism” — enabling routing/activation of understanding prior to completion of an utterance.

3. Grammar further framed as a form of data compression.

4. Interaction Dynamics equated with Dialectics.

B. Loop-Based Critique of Machine Learning

1. Premise: a “zero-th differential estimator in feedback loop” permits open-loop gradient-descent training.

2. Assertion: effective understanding requires looping, not linear processing — stated as a “fundamental flaw in machine learning: not loop-based.”

3. Each processing step framed as a loop shifting the path through the neural network.

4. Illustrative example: syllabification of “into” as “in” + “two,” producing two activation pathways that “co-mingle” to create new understanding.

Source: satoshiofficial/RodBeck and BRVC-ORG/RodBeck README files.

VI. Image / Artifact Annotations

Repository-embedded “interpolation” notes attached to two specific images (IMG_4742 and IMG_9897) within the RodBeck materials; included here as they appear to constitute embedded marginalia relevant to the essay's broader technical-narrative voice.

A. Subject Matter of the Annotated Images

1. Framed as a NoCode UI breakdown/walkthrough using a One-Time Pad (OTP) methodology.

2. References a “PublicPrivate Node Operator” concept and discussion of STOP/GO points of failure in a hashing/notation context without “Core access.”

3. Notes a pre-Web2 code visualization visible in the lower-right-hand corner of the source image.

B. Adjacent Topics Raised in the Annotation

1. International Date Line; U.S. railroad and U.S.C. references; Louisiana pre/post-1803 historical framing.

2. Distinction drawn between generative/automatic machine-learning recursion and “classical” (pre on-chip neural architecture) code requiring constant supervision.

3. Footnoted commentary on UNIX/legacy operating systems' handling of dates and cloud-hosted virtualized GPU/multi-distro environments prior to 2021, including Docker-era considerations.

4. Capital cost of the illustrated setup cited as “>$250.”

5. Closing aside crediting “Show(s) of Force” concept to Jason Powell (USSF), with commentary on governmental accountability.

Source: satoshiofficial/RodBeck and BRVC-ORG/RodBeck README files (“INTERPOLATION(S) ON IMG_4742 AND IMG_9897”).

VII. Venture Timeline — regal.tech, llc

A. Corporate Existence

1. Founded and led by Brock Angelle Thibodeaux as Founder, President, and CEO.

2. Company operative period: 1 March 2020 – 3 April 2021.

3. LLC formally active: 18 August 2020 – 4 April 2021.

4. AI/ML intellectual property subsequently acquired on 4 April 2021.

B. Domain Acquisition Timeline (via domains.google)

1. regalgfx.com — registered 6 May 2020 (coincides with the month the RodBeck name was selected for investors).

2. regal.graphics, gfx.llc, regalholdings.biz — registered 23 May 2020.

3. regal.technology and regalventures.co — registered 11 August 2020.

4. fivesecondcovidtest.com, fivesecondcovidtest.org, 5secondcovidtest.com, 5secondcovid.com, and regaltech.llc — registered 13 August 2020 (the “five-second” naming directly echoing the chest X-ray evaluation speed claim).

5. rodbeckmethod.com, rodbeckmethod.net, rodbeckmethod.org, and therbeckmethod.org — registered 19 August 2020.

6. robemethod.com, robemethod.org, robemethod.net — registered 21 August 2020.

7. brockthibodeaux.me — registered 15 September 2020.

Source: satoshiofficial/RodBeck and BRVC-ORG/RodBeck README files (“Domains registered/used, via domains.google”).

C. Public Validation

1. KATC News coverage published 12 August 2020, providing third-party journalistic confirmation of the narrative, timeline, and naming rationale — published one day before the cluster of “fivesecondcovid” and “rodbeckmethod” domain registrations.

VIII. External Documentation and Verification Sources

A. NSA Cryptologic Memorial — official memorial page/PDF for SFC Antonio Rodriguez.

B. Northside Chapel — published obituary for Kathryn Casey Beckwith.

C. Internet Archive (Wayback Machine) — archived snapshot (22 May 2021) of a Crunchbase organization listing for “Regal Tech.”

D. Nola.com — referenced photo/article asset tied to the author's COVID-19 narrative (“aca-covidthibodeaux” image reference).

E. KATC News — “UL grad and former U.S. Army Ranger developing technology to slow the spread of COVID-19,” published 12 August 2020, updated 18 August 2020; authored under KATC's Coronavirus/Lafayette Parish coverage.

F. New York Times — referenced (via KATC) 17 February 2020 report on the Nangarhar Province ambush and its connection to U.S.–Taliban peace-talk developments.

IX. Repository Ecosystem

A. satoshiofficial/2-9-20 — the essay's dedicated repository; contains the essay's framing README and Spotify playlist reference (1 star, 4 commits).

B. BRVC-ORG/RodBeck — origin repository for the RodBeck Method materials (template repository; 3 stars, 1 fork, 23 commits); contains the full README documentation of the Method, NLP notes, image annotations, and domain timeline.

C. satoshiofficial/RodBeck — forked from BRVC-ORG/RodBeck, carrying identical README content (2 stars, 28 commits).

D. Shared file assets across both RodBeck repositories include: multiple image files (IMG_4261, IMG_4722, IMG_4726–IMG_4728, IMG_4742, IMG_6930, IMG_6937–IMG_6939, IMG_7516, IMG_9897, and one additional 32064528-F4AD… .JPG file in the fork only); two Google Cloud Billing Account PDF exports; and a copy of the SFC Antonio Rodriguez NSA memorial PDF (SFC_Antonio_Rodriguez_FINAL.pdf).

X. Cross-Reference: BRVC-ORG/Prospectus-Draft

A. Search Result

1. The literal string “RodBeck” does not appear within BRVC-ORG/Prospectus-Draft.

2. However, the Prospectus-Draft's 22 January entry (year context: 2026 cycle of the running document) separately memorializes the same individual honored in the RodBeck name.

B. Relevant Passage (Paraphrased)

1. The entry reflects on the author's ongoing R&D/ethical-hacking work and states, in connection with the approaching anniversary of his passing, that SFC Antonio Rodriguez — described there as “one of the finest Rangers and Special Operators (to include Cryptologic Linguists)” the author has known — was “KIA 8 February 2020,” and that building the digital-asset economy without keeping such losses in mind “would be unethical.”

2. This passage reuses the 8 February 2020 date (matching the RodBeck repositories rather than the KATC article's 7 February 2020 date) and reaffirms the same dedicatory throughline first established in the RodBeck Method naming.

C. Significance for the Essay Outline

1. Establishes that the dedication to Rodriguez is not a one-time naming choice confined to 2020, but a recurring, multi-year memorial thread carried into the author's later (2024–2026) venture documentation.

2. Supports treating “2•9•20” as the originating narrative for a dedication pattern that persists across the author's subsequent work.

Source: BRVC-ORG/Prospectus-Draft, “Month of January 2026” section, 22 January entry.

XI. Closing Themes and Reflective Throughline

A. Illness and mortality (the author's own COVID-19 case; Rodriguez's combat death; Beckwith's lifelong illness) as the triple catalyst for a technical project.

B. Memorialization-through-naming as a recurring authorial device, visible both in 2020 (RodBeck) and in later BRVC materials (2026 Prospectus references to the same loss).

C. The essay's stated thesis — fringe technology emerging from uncertainty — mirrored structurally by the essay's own form: a personal narrative essay that embeds, rather than separates, a full technical specification within it.

D. Continuity between the wartime/medical dedication of RodBeck and the author's later blockchain/oracle work (BRVC, DOROTHY) suggests “2•9•20” functions, within the author's broader corpus, as an origin narrative for a recurring ethical and naming framework.

Compiled from: github.com/satoshiofficial/2-9-20; github.com/satoshiofficial/RodBeck; github.com/BRVC-ORG/RodBeck; github.com/BRVC-ORG/Prospectus-Draft; and katc.com (12 Aug. 2020). This document is an organizational outline only and does not itself constitute the essay text.